

The Spirit Breathes upon the Word

- 1 The Spirit breathes upon the Word,
and brings the truth to sight;
precepts and promises afford
a sanctifying light.
- 2 A glory gilds the sacred page,
majestic, like the sun:
it gives a light to ev'ry age;
it gives, but borrows none.
- 3 The Hand that gave it still supplies
the gracious light and heat:
his truths upon the nations rise;
they rise, but never set.
- 4 Let everlasting thanks be thine
for such a bright display
as makes a world of darkness shine
with beams of heav'nly day.
- 5 My soul rejoices to pursue
the steps of him I love,
till glory breaks upon my view
in brighter worlds above.

Words: William Cowper, 1779

Music: Irish melody; arr. Charles V. Stanford, 1906

Tune: ST. COLUMBA · CM · Scripture: John 14:26

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